

MARVEL

ONE-SHOT

1

IRON MAN[®]

TITANIUM



VARDIN

KILLER COMPUTE

THE 4 TRAIN, 8:20 AM...



TARGET: UNIDENTIFIED

TARGET: UNIDENTIFIED



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PEPPER'S APARTMENT;
ONE HOUR
EARLIER...

Pepper,
I am so excited
about this meeting
today.

If we can
sell these dignitaries
on the Vitruvius Prototype,
we're going to revolutionize
construction in the
Third World!

It barely
compromises the
ratio of input force
and force exerted,
all without hydraulics
or a continuous
trac --

Tony. I *adore*
you, but there's no way
I can share your enthusiasm
for mechatronic engineering
before a cup of
coffee.



The Ambassador
texted to let me know
that the group left the
U.N. on time this
morning.

Also, there's
a fresh suit in
your office closet,
since I am 100%
sure that you're
still wearing
the suit from
yesterday.



Of
course. The
fabricator
didn't say
there were
any issues,
right?

None. I
had him run
through the actions
we're highlighting
today.



Thanks for
picking that up.
There's no one
else I'd trust
to do that.

It's right by my
house, Tony. No
trouble at all.

I
confirmed
that the Power-
Point files were
loaded and the
holographic
projection unit
tested.

It
won't have
that bluish tint
it did yester-
day.

Where
would I
be without
you?



Hopelessly,
hopelessly lost.
I'm hanging up the
phone now.

Before
you go, what
was the status
of Eddie's
mustache?



In full
effect. That guy
is one goofy
fabricator.

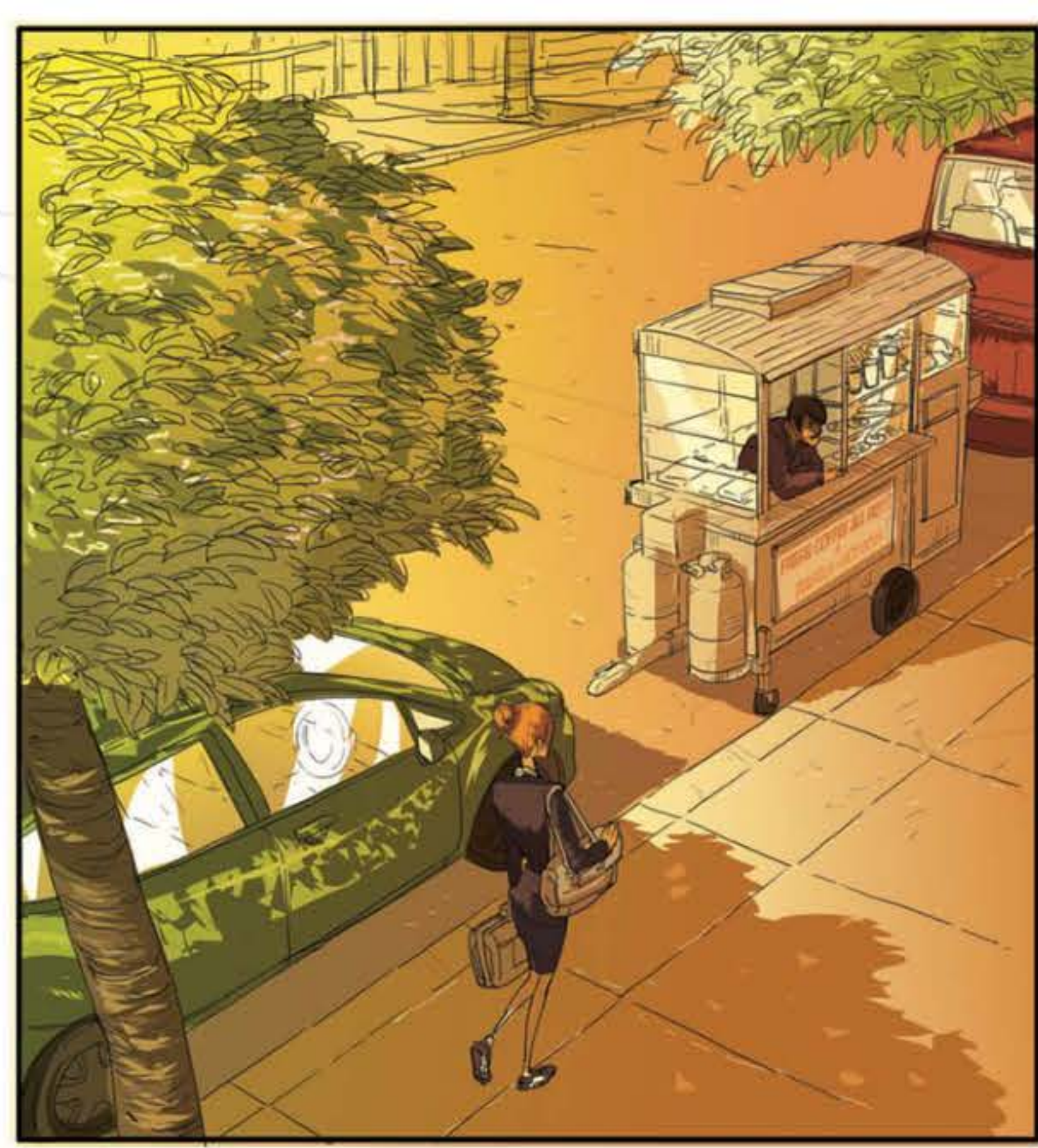
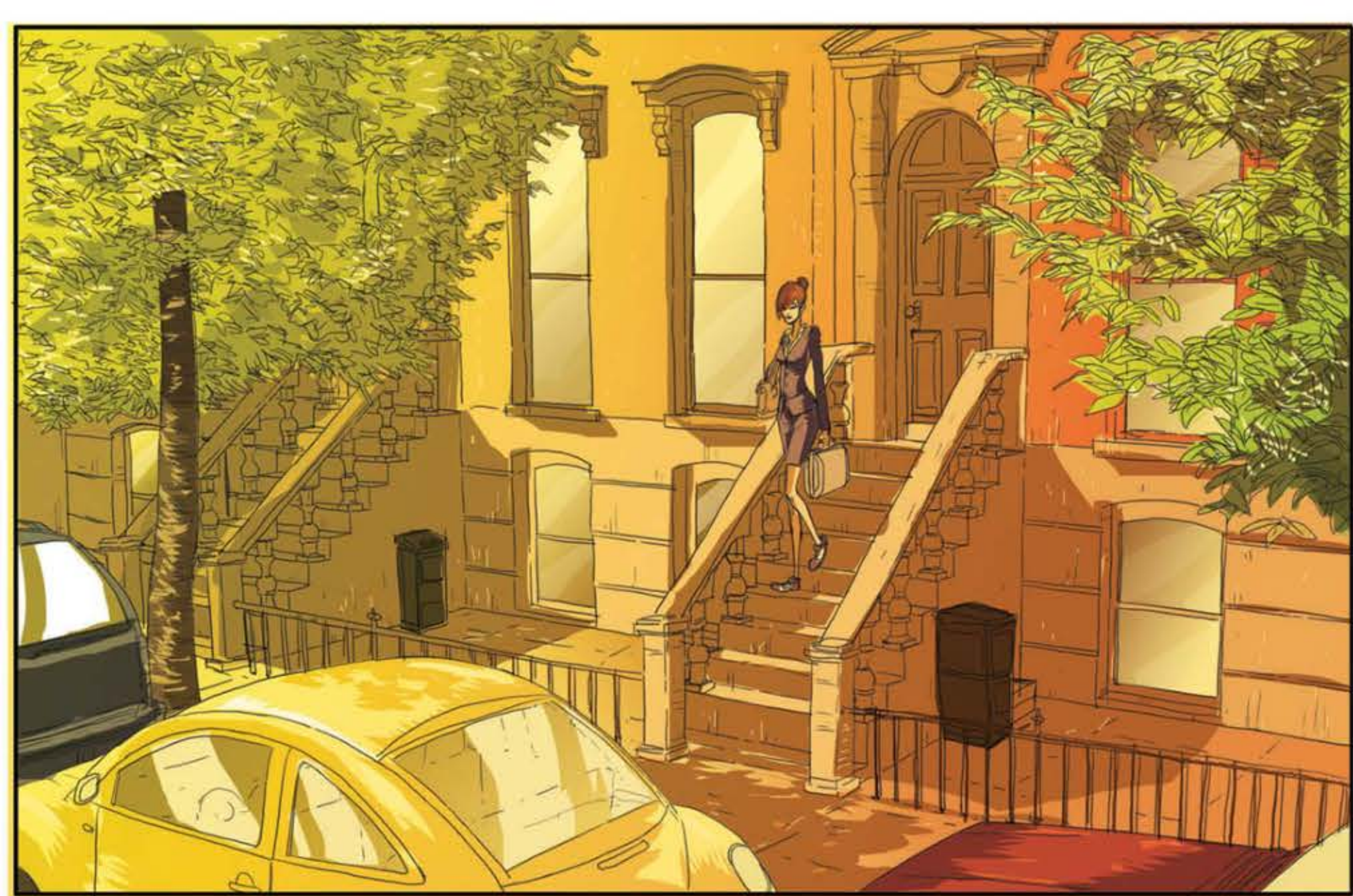
They
all are. I think
he's trying to
one-up me.

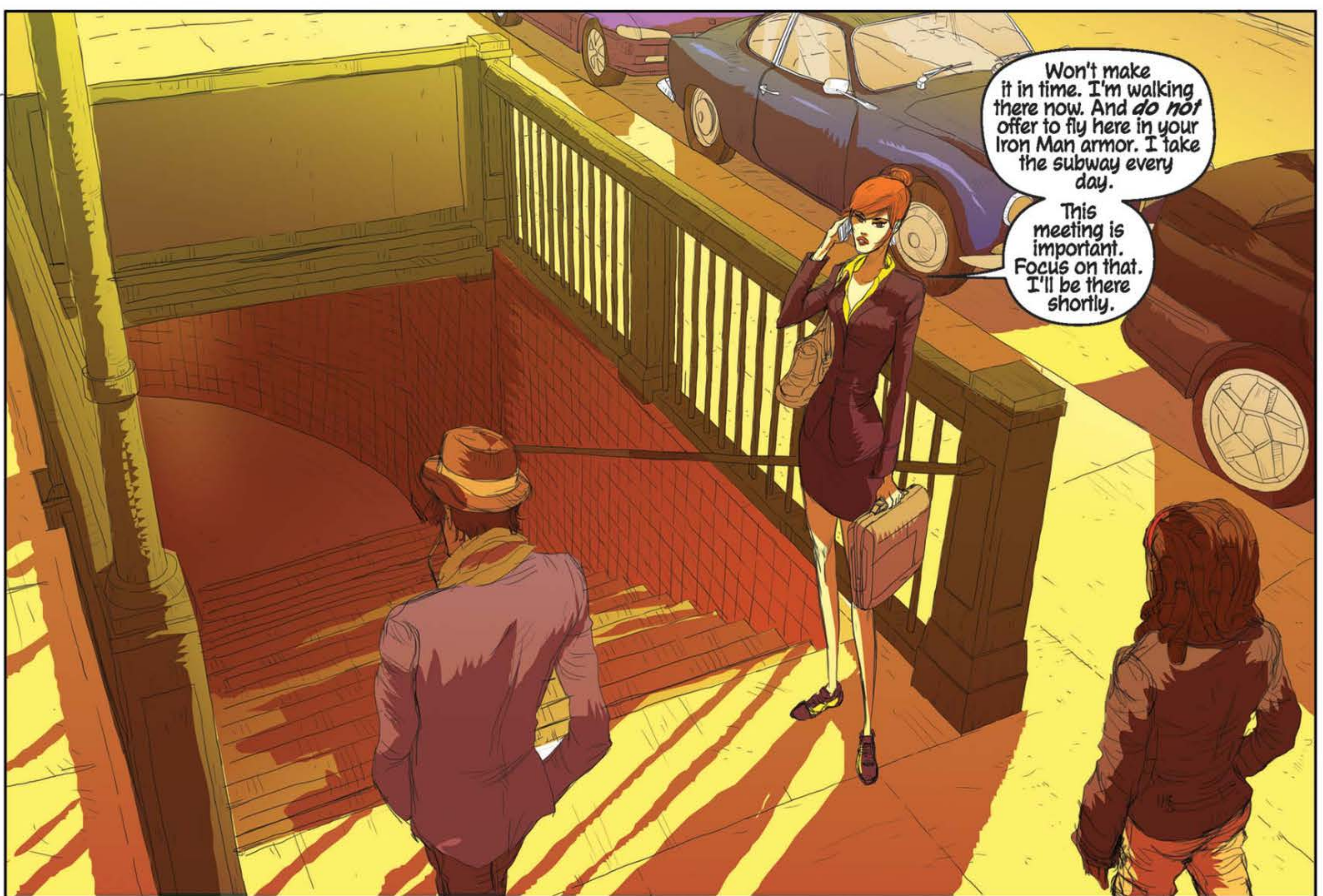
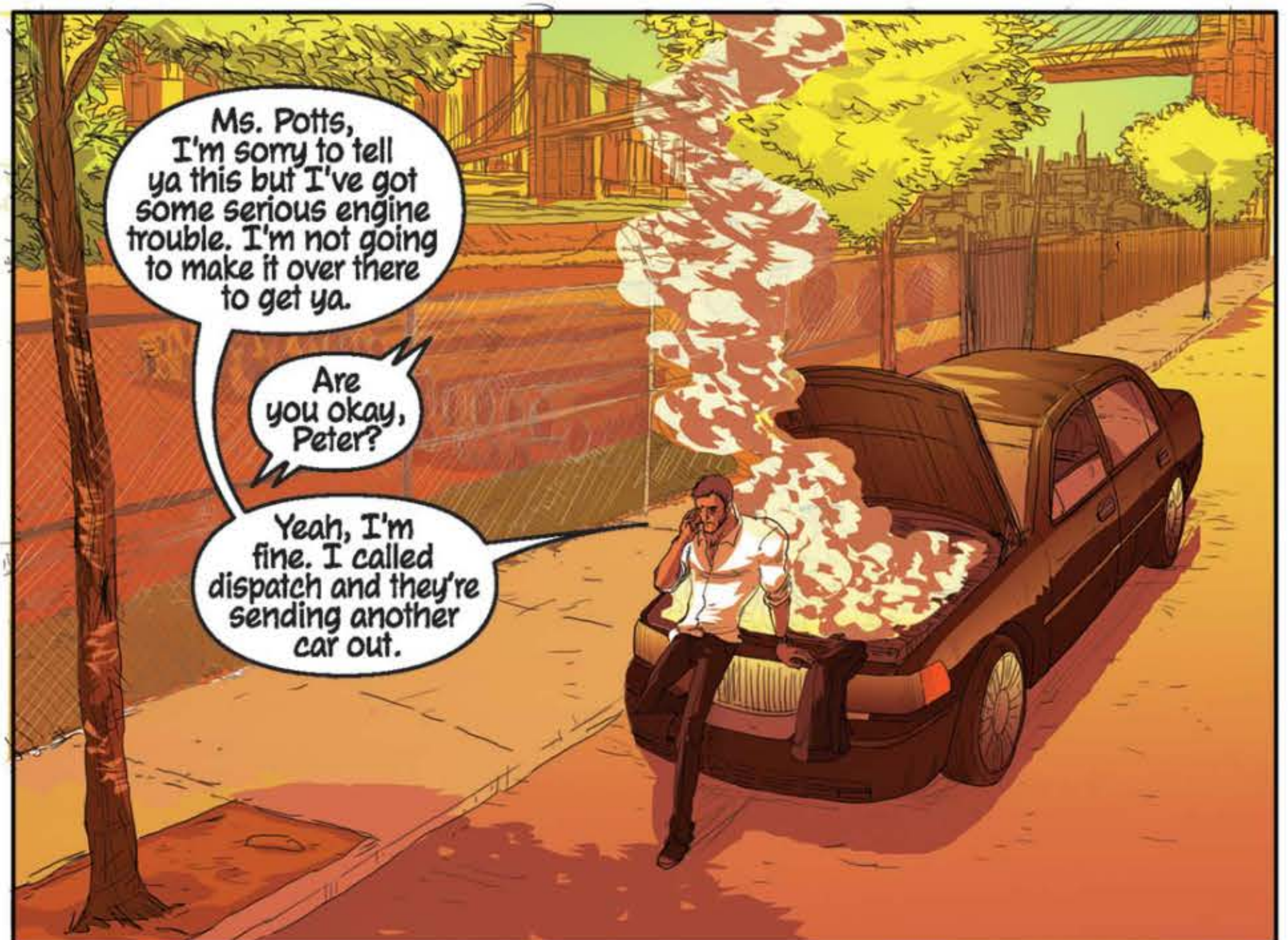


Well,
he's succeeding.
I'll see you in a bit,
Tony. No more
espresso today,
okay?

Call
me when
the driver
arrives.

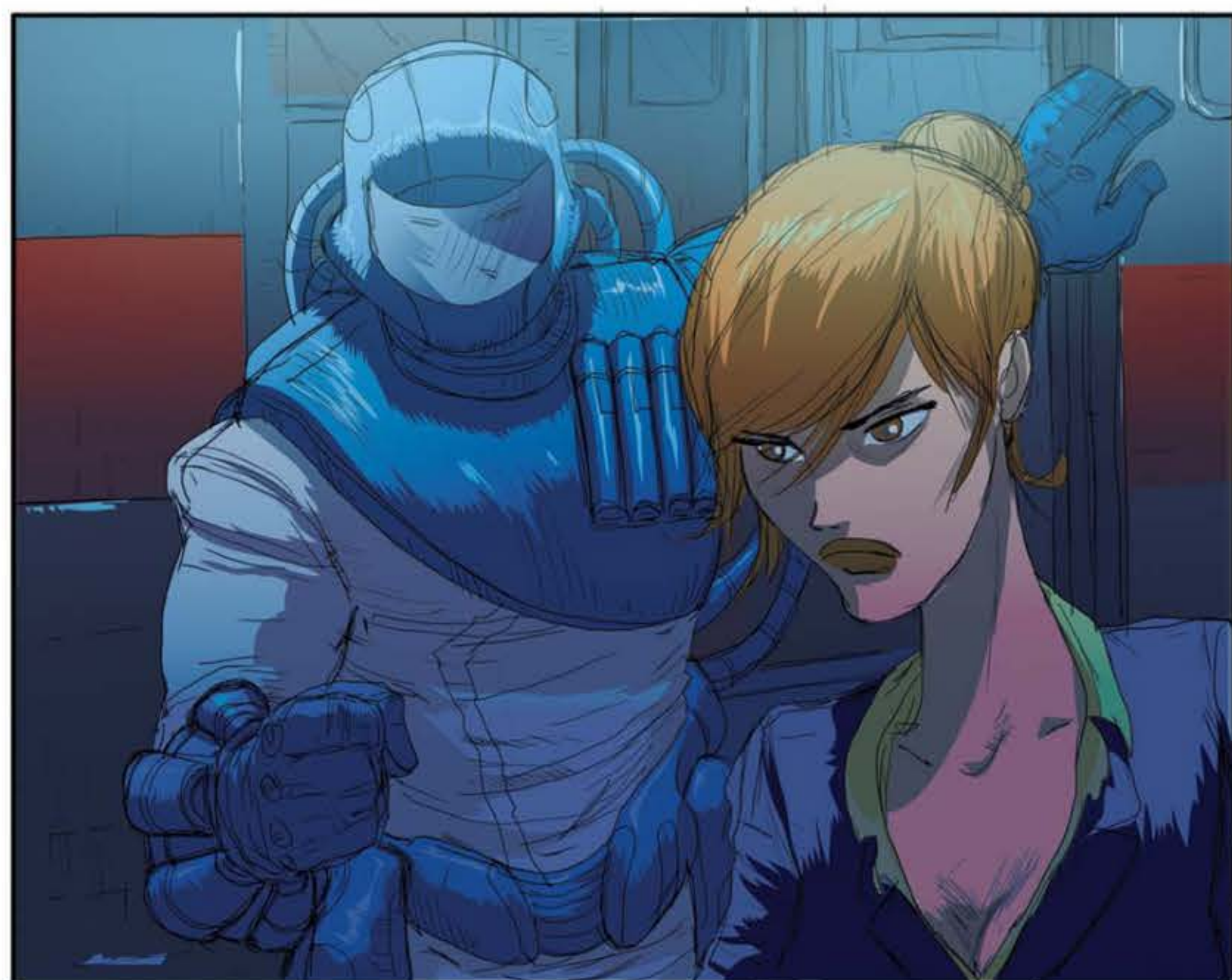
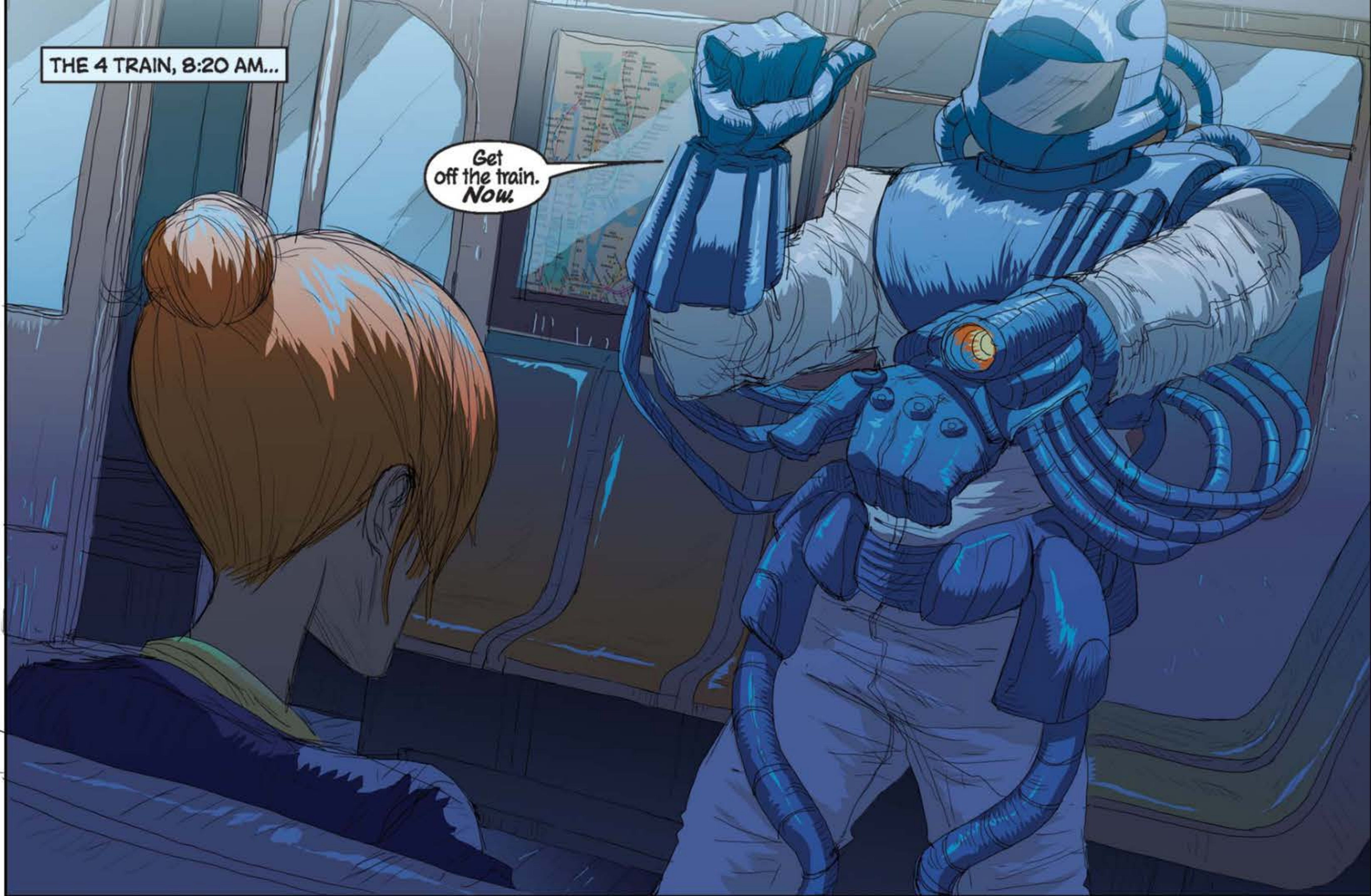
Shave
before you
put on that
suit.





THE 4 TRAIN, 8:20 AM...

Get
off the train.
Now.



Ooof!





RUKRUK! RUKRUK! RUKRUK!

YESTERDAY.

What was it like working for Stark?

Dude, he never even met Stark. Felton was like, his secretary.

Bite me. I was -- am, I *am* an engineer. Stark had me doing armor autopsies on Iron Man villains.

Wait, you were a mortician? Did you dress like Morticia Addams? I always thought of you more as an Uncle Fester type.

I hate you, Jacob.

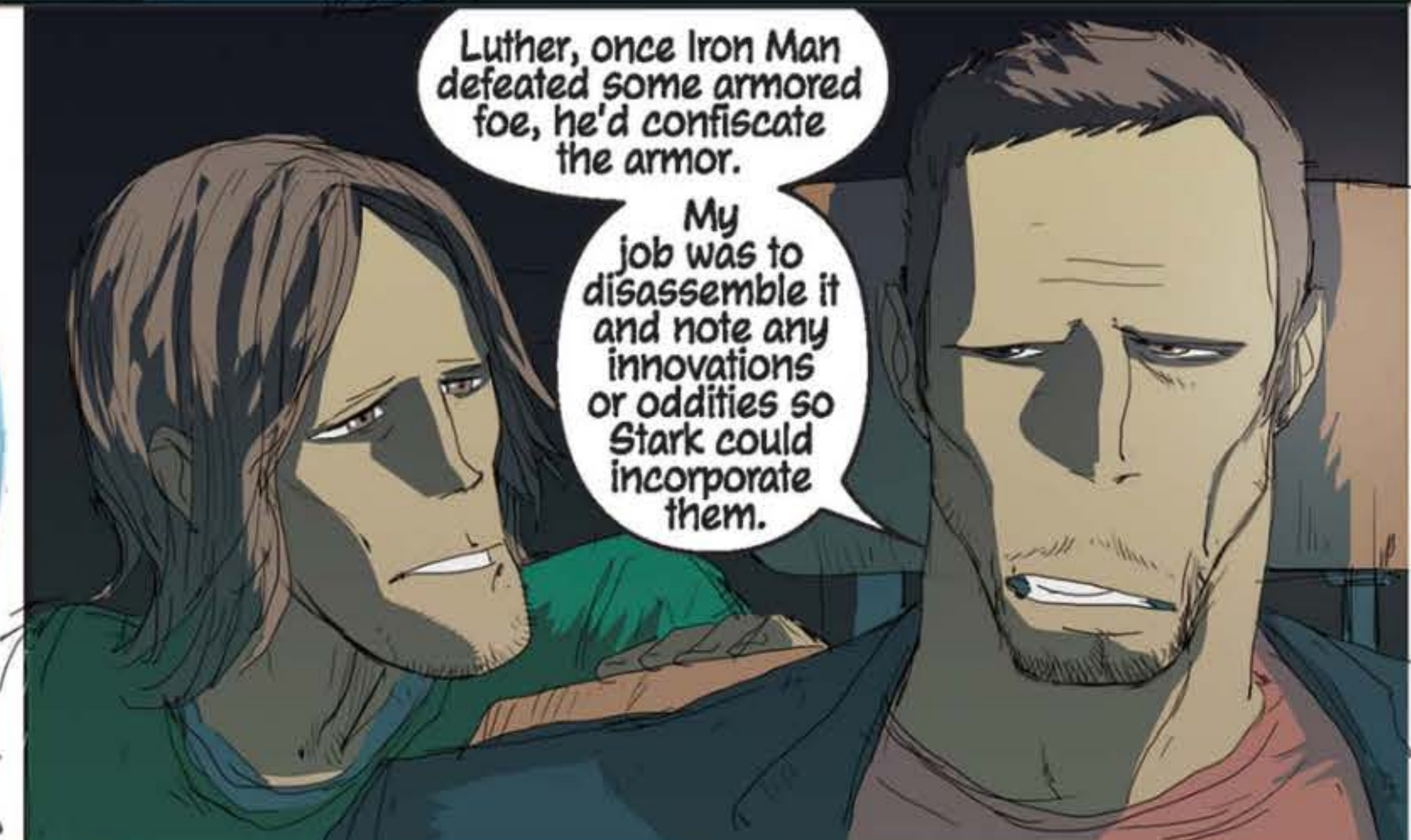


"There she is. She's got the case."



Luther, once Iron Man defeated some armored foe, he'd confiscate the armor.

My job was to disassemble it and note any innovations or oddities so Stark could incorporate them.



Unfortunately, Uncle Fester here came to work strung out and hung-over so many times he got fired.

It was one time. I had a hot streak going and next thing I knew, it's 9 AM and I'm late for work.

With a pocket full of Benjamins, I tried to talk to Stark but --

Stark fired his ass on the spot. Dude does not play.

My, a lot has happened while I was locked up. You sure you don't want to just snag her right here?

Yes. Let's get home.





That makes three of us. Look, it still sounds risky to me. What else have you got?

I've got no choice. I thought I could make up the cash on the Monday Night game, but my hopes were torn up with Westbrook's MCL.

My bookie will take the armor as payment. It's the only way I don't wind up in the East River just like Dad.

This *has* to happen. Let's go over it one last time:

Once the subway is sealed off, Stark's secretary --

Sealed off Stark's secretary. You have a gift for alliteration, brother. You really should reconsider recording that rap album, Feltie Fell.



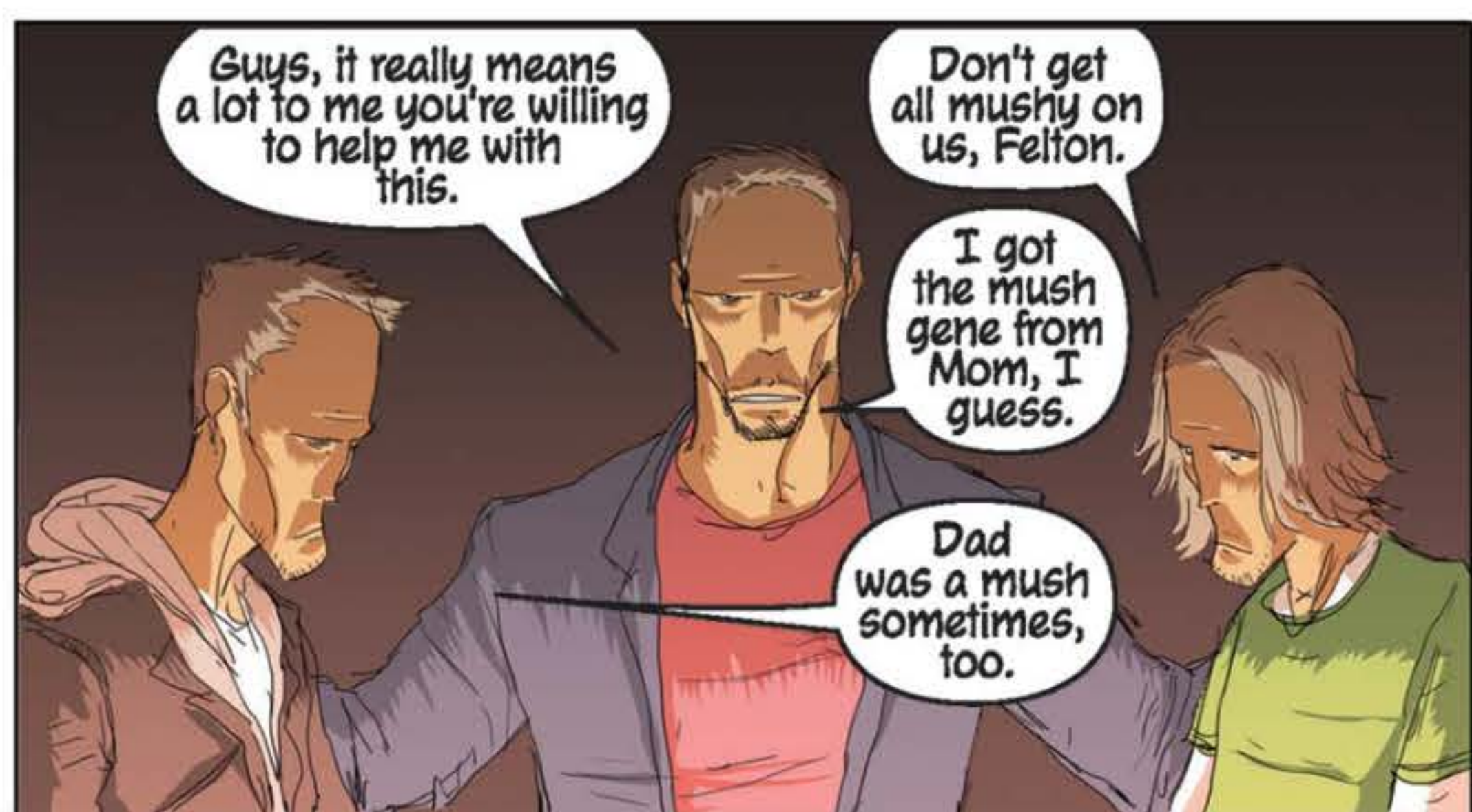
Then we head to the router box. Once I get the text from you, I flip the switch turning off the power to the train. But why won't she just call Stark to come get her?

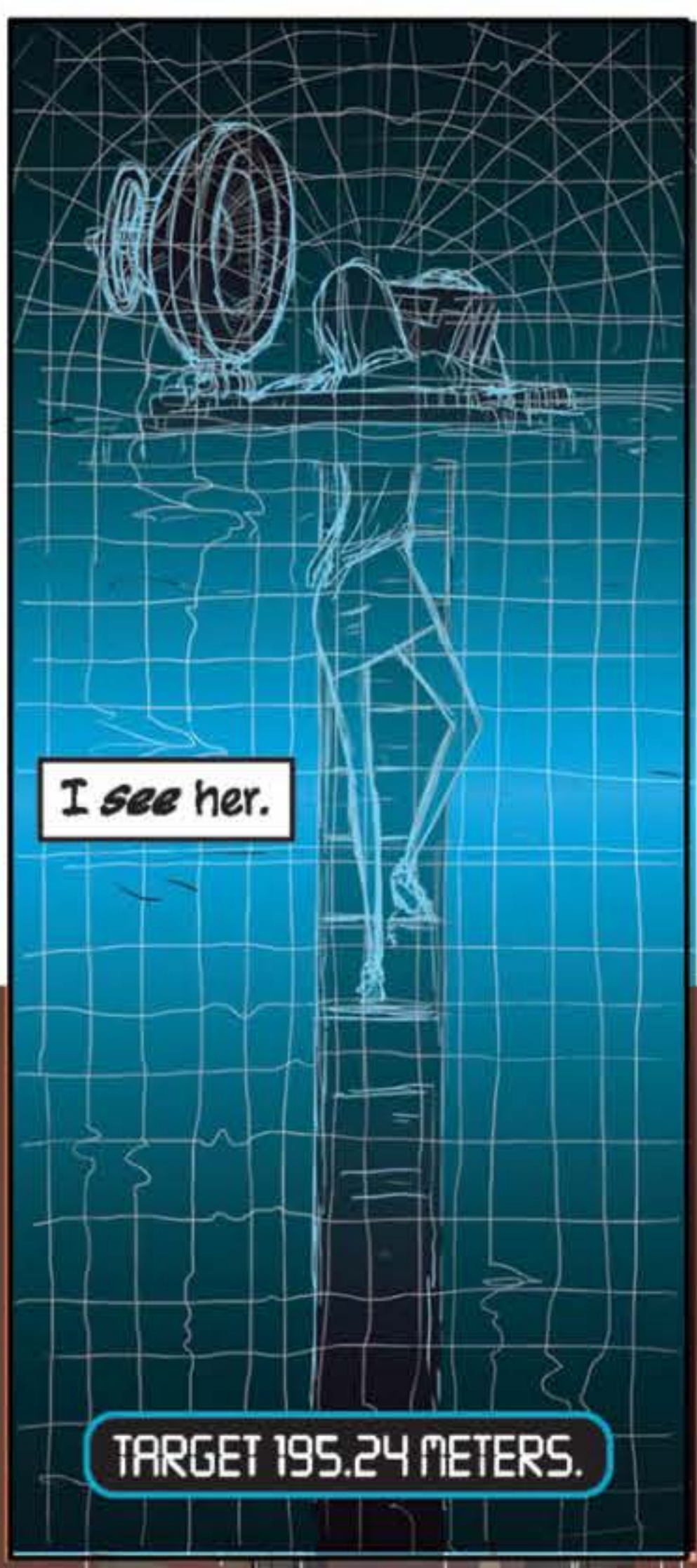
According to the emails I intercepted, this meeting is essential to the project.



Without her ride, the bridge sealed off, and rush hour traffic...

...the only way she can make the meeting on time is the subway.









LATER...

...so the Duke accidentally puts his king in check-mate and ol' Ben Franklin dramatically snatches it up. The Duke says "We do not snatch our kings so!" and Franklin says, "We do in America!"

HAHAHAHA!

Mr. Stark, Pepper is on the way in.



Great. Ladies and gentlemen, I apologize for the delay...

...but I assure you it was worth the wait --



Sorry, folks.

Just a little trouble on the subway this morning...



END.